UMEED E SUBH Website: UI Design System and Layout Guide

Oct 26, 2026 · @Abdul Moeid Rao

The site should feel like a warm, real, community-built society: a white base, the logo's golden and orange accents, real photographs, and restrained motion. This guide covers colors, typography, the loading animation, the hero section, every page layout and the animation rules. It is the companion to the website plan and build guide.

1. Design Direction: Real, Not Template-Made

Most generated sites look alike: purple gradients, floating glass cards, stock illustrations, emoji icons, three identical cards in a row and vague slogans. UMEED E SUBH has something those sites lack: ten-plus years of real work and real faces. The design should show that.

Avoid	Do instead
Purple or blue gradients, glassmorphism everywhere	Flat white and warm paper backgrounds with one gold accent
Stock photos and 3D illustrations	The society's own photos and video, shot at Gate 2, in the classroom, in the lab, at drives
Three equal cards in a row on every section	Mixed layouts: alternating image and text rows, one large feature plus a list, big numerals
Emoji or generic icon packs as decoration	Few, simple line icons; the logo's rays and pen-nib as the one recurring motif
Slogans like "Empowering the future"	Plain, specific lines with numbers: "70+ children. Free. Every evening."
Everything centered	Left-aligned editorial headings, generous white space, a few intentional asymmetric blocks
Animation on every element	One purposeful motion per screen, motion that explains something

Signature ideas to repeat across the site

- **Sunrise motif.** The name means "hope of dawn". Golden rays from the logo rise behind the hero headline, draw in on the loader, and appear as a thin divider between sections.
- **Pen-nib line.** A single gold line that "writes" under headings, a nod to the pen-nib in the logo and the mission of literacy.
- **Urdu touches.** The logo carries Urdu calligraphy. Use the Urdu tagline once in the hero and once in the footer, in a proper Nastaliq font, not as decoration everywhere.
- **Real faces.** Large, honest photographs with guardian consent, never cropped into tiny circles.

2. Color System (White plus Logo Colors)

The palette below is measured from the supplied logo files (light and dark versions): the gold of the ribbon and rays, the coral-red ribbon ends, the silver pen-nib, and the black and white of the book. **The Graphics team should confirm these measured values**

against the master logo file and keep them in one place (the CSS variables).

Role	Name	Hex	Where it is used
Base	White	#FFFFFF	Page background, cards, forms
Alternate base	Paper	#FAF7F0	Alternate sections, quote blocks, footer top
Text and dark surfaces	Ink	#1B1A1F	Headings, body text, footer, hero overlay, loader text
Primary accent	Sunrise Gold	#FCC609	Donate and Sponsor buttons, rays motif, highlights, counter underlines
Secondary accent	Ember	#EB543B	Hover states, ribbon motif, small tags, active links
Supporting text	Pen Gray	#6E7178	Secondary text, captions, icons
Lines	Mist	#E7E3DA	Borders, dividers, table rules
Soft tint	Dawn	#FFF3D1	Gold-tinted bands (CSP section), selected states
Success	Leaf	#2F7D4F	Verified donation, valid certificate
Error	Brick	#C62F2F	Form errors, invalid certificate

Also in the logo: Amber #F5B226 (outer rays), Orange #F07D3E (middle of the ribbon ends) and Silver #D1D2D4 (the pen-nib). The ribbon blends gold into coral, so any gradient on the site should run only from Gold through Orange to Ember, as the ribbon does, and only on small accents such as the loader ribbon and divider lines.

Proportions: about 65% white and paper, 20% ink and gray, 10% gold, 5% ember. Gold is the loudest color, so use it for one main action per screen.

Contrast rules

- Never set gold text on white. Gold is a background: ink text on gold.
- Ember on white only for large or bold text and icons. Check small text with a contrast checker (WebAIM) before using it.
- White text only on Ink or on the hero overlay (section 5).
- Keep body text Ink on White or Paper.

Theme variables (paste once, change in one place)

```
:root {
  --white: #FFFFFF;
  --paper: #FAF7F0;
  --ink: #1B1A1F;
  --gold: #FCC609;
  --ember: #EB543B;
  --gray: #6E7178;
  --mist: #E7E3DA;
  --dawn: #FFF3D1;
  --leaf: #2F7D4F;
  --brick: #C62F2F;
  --radius: 10px;
  --ease: cubic-bezier(.22, 1, .36, 1);
}
```

In Tailwind, map the same names under `theme.extend.colors` (for example `gold`, `ember`, `ink`, `paper`), so classes read `bg-gold text-ink`.

Dark mode (optional). The society has a dark-background logo, so a dark theme is possible. Build the site on semantic tokens and map them per theme. Gold and Ember stay the same, because they read well on black.

```
:root { --bg: var(--white); --surface: var(--paper); --text: var(--ink); --
muted: var(--gray); --line: var(--mist); }
[data-theme='dark'] {
  --bg: #0B0B0D; --surface: #151518; --text: #F6F4EE; --muted: #A5A8AE; --
line: #2A2A2E;
}
```

In dark mode, swap to the dark logo, keep gold buttons with Ink text, and allow Gold as text color (it passes on black).

3. Typography

Use	Font	Notes
Display headings	Fraunces (serif), weight 600	Warm, editorial, human. Avoids the usual all-sans look

Use	Font	Notes
Body and interface	Source Sans 3	Clear at small sizes on cheap phone screens
Urdu tagline	Noto Nastaliq Urdu	Only for the tagline and logo text, large size, generous line height

Load fonts with `next/font` (self-hosted, no layout shift) and subset them to the characters needed.

Style	Size	Line height
H1 (hero)	clamp(2.6rem, 6vw, 5rem)	1.05
H2	clamp(1.9rem, 3.5vw, 3rem)	1.15
H3	1.5rem	1.3
Body	1.0625rem	1.65
Small and captions	0.875rem	1.5
Big numerals (impact)	clamp(3rem, 7vw, 6rem), Fraunces	1

Keep text blocks to 65 to 75 characters per line.

4. Logo Usage and Layout Grid

- Two logo files are supplied, one for light backgrounds and one for dark backgrounds. Ask the Graphics team to export both as SVG or transparent PNG, plus a compact mark (nib, rays, book and ribbon without the curved lettering) for the header and favicon.
- Header logo height 44 px on desktop, 36 px on mobile. Clear space around the logo equal to the height of the pen-nib.
- The UET Taxila logo sits in the footer and on the About page as "Official Welfare Society of UET Taxila", never next to the main logo in the header.

Which logo goes where

Place	Version
Header on white (after scrolling)	Light logo, compact mark
Header over the hero video	Dark logo (white book and lettering), compact mark
Loading screen (white)	Light logo, full emblem, animated
Footer (Ink background)	Dark logo, full emblem
Favicon	Compact mark
Social share image and video end-card	Dark logo on black
Certificates and print	Light logo on white

Fixes needed on the supplied files: the light logo is only 294 px wide, too small for sharp display on modern phones, and the dark logo is a JPG with the black background baked in, so it cannot sit on photos or video. Ask for vector (SVG) or transparent PNG files of at least 1080 px. The curved tagline in the emblem is unreadable at header size, which is why the header uses the compact mark.

Grid and spacing

- 12-column grid, content width 1200 px, side padding 20 px mobile and 48 px desktop.
- Spacing in steps of 8 px. Section padding 72 px mobile, 128 px desktop.
- Radius 10 px on cards and inputs, 999 px on buttons and tags. Almost no shadows: use Mist borders and white space instead. One soft shadow only for floating elements (sticky donate bar, modals).

5. Loading Screen (Logo Animation)

A short opening animation that draws the logo, then lifts like a sunrise curtain to reveal the hero. It plays **once per visit** and takes about 2.4 seconds.

Time	What happens
0.0 to 0.3 s	Plain white screen. The pen-nib mark fades in and scales from 90% to 100%

Time	What happens
0.3 to 1.0 s	Golden rays draw outward from the nib, one after another (SVG stroke drawing)
1.0 to 1.5 s	The open book rises from its spine, then the orange-red ribbon sweeps in from the left and its Urdu words fade in
1.5 to 1.9 s	The curved lettering "Struggle for Literate Pakistan" fades in around the rays. A thin gold line under the emblem completes (the progress indicator)
1.9 to 2.4 s	The white panel slides up and away (translateY to -100%) while the hero headline begins to reveal

Rules

- Real readiness: the curtain lifts only when the hero poster image and fonts are loaded, with a minimum of 1.2 s and a maximum of 3 s.
- Show it once per session (store a flag in sessionStorage). On later pages and repeat visits skip it or play only a 300 ms fade.
- Build it as inline SVG and CSS or a light Framer Motion component, so it never delays the first paint.
- `prefers-reduced-motion`: show the logo with a simple fade, no drawing, no curtain.
- Fully accessible: the loader has `aria-hidden` after it ends and never traps focus.

Component outline (Framer Motion)

```
'use client';
import { motion, AnimatePresence } from 'motion/react';
import { useEffect, useState } from 'react';

export default function Loader() {
  const [show, setShow] = useState(false);
  useEffect(() => {
    if (sessionStorage.getItem('seen')) return;
    setShow(true);
    const t = setTimeout(() => { setShow(false);
sessionStorage.setItem('seen', '1'); }, 2400);
    return () => clearTimeout(t);
```

```
  }, []);
  return (
    <AnimatePresence>
      {show && (
        <motion.div className='fixed inset-0 z-50 grid place-items-center bg-
white'
          exit={{ y: '-100%' }} transition={{ duration: 0.6, ease: [0.76, 0,
0.24, 1] }}>
          {/* inline SVG: nib, rays (pathLength 0 to 1), ribbon, wordmark */}
        </motion.div>
      )}
    </AnimatePresence>
  );
}
```

6. Hero Section (Home)

Goal: in three seconds a visitor sees that this is a real society helping real children, and finds the Donate button.

Structure (desktop)

1. **Background:** full-width looping video (10 to 15 seconds, muted, no audio) of real moments: the evening classroom, the IT Box lab, Chaddar stitching, a distribution event. Fall back to a single strong photograph.
2. **Overlay** so text is always readable: an Ink gradient, dark on the left where the text sits and lighter on the right, plus a soft dark band at the bottom.
3. **Content, left aligned,** about 55% of the width: small gold label ("Founded 2014 · UET Taxila"), the headline, one supporting sentence, two buttons.
4. **Sunrise motif:** thin gold rays rising from the bottom-left behind the headline at low opacity.
5. **Impact strip:** a white card that overlaps the bottom edge of the hero with four counters (children taught, certificates issued, years of service, drives completed). Real numbers only.
6. **Scroll cue:** a small gold line that slowly draws downward at the bottom center.

Headline options (pick one with the society)

- "Every child deserves a first step." (a nod to Pehla Qadam)
- "Free classes. Real skills. Every evening."

- "Since 2014, students teaching students."

Under it, one line such as "UMEED E SUBH is the official welfare society of UET Taxila. We teach 70+ children, train students in IT, and stand beside families in need." Add the Urdu tagline in small type under the buttons.

Buttons: primary "Donate" (gold, ink text), secondary "Sponsor a child" (white outline on the overlay).

Overlay CSS

```
.hero { position: relative; min-height: 100svh; color: #fff; overflow:
hidden; }
.hero video, .hero img { position: absolute; inset: 0; width: 100%; height:
100%; object-fit: cover; }
.hero::before {
  content: ''; position: absolute; inset: 0; z-index: 1;
  background:
    linear-gradient(90deg, rgba(27,26,31,.82) 0%, rgba(27,26,31,.55) 45%,
rgba(27,26,31,.15) 100%),
    linear-gradient(0deg, rgba(27,26,31,.55) 0%, rgba(27,26,31,0) 40%);
}
.hero .content { position: relative; z-index: 2; }
@media (max-width: 768px) {
  .hero::before { background: rgba(27,26,31,.68); }
}
```

Readability checks

- Test the text against the brightest frame of the video, not the average frame.
- White headline on the overlay must pass 4.5:1 contrast. If a frame fails, darken the overlay or reposition the shot.
- No text on faces. Keep faces in the right half, text in the left half.

Hero motion

- The headline reveals line by line from behind a mask (translateY 100% to 0, 700 ms, 120 ms stagger), starting as the loader curtain lifts.
- The video drifts with a very slow zoom (1.0 to 1.06 over the loop) if only a photo is available.
- A gentle parallax: rays move up slightly faster than the background on scroll.
- Counters count up when the strip enters the screen.

Video and performance

- 1920 x 1080, H.264 MP4 plus WebM, under 3 MB, 24 fps, no audio. Add a poster image (WebP) loaded first.
- On mobile, slow connections or data-saver mode, show the poster image only. Respect `prefers-reduced-motion`.
- Include a small pause button for the video (accessibility).
- `preload='metadata'`, `muted`, `playsInline`, `loop`.

7. Navigation and Footer

- **Header:** transparent over the hero with the dark-background logo (compact mark), turns white with the light-background logo and a thin Mist border after 80 px of scroll (250 ms). It hides when scrolling down and returns when scrolling up.
- **Links:** About, Projects, Teams, Impact, Gallery, News, Contact. A permanent gold **Donate** button on the right.
- **Mobile:** a full-screen white menu with large Fraunces links, the Urdu tagline at the bottom and the Donate button pinned at the bottom of the screen.
- **Footer:** Ink background. Four columns: logo and mission, projects, get involved, contact and map to Gate 2. A gold ray divider at the top, the UET Taxila credit, social links and the Urdu tagline.

8. Page Layouts

Home (section by section)

#	Section	Layout and notes
1	Hero	Video and overlay, headline, two buttons, impact strip (section 6)
2	Mission statement	One large Fraunces paragraph on white (3 to 4 lines), a photo offset to the right overlapping the next section. Key words highlighted with a gold underline that draws in

#	Section	Layout and notes
3	Regular projects	Four alternating rows, not cards: big photo one side, text with a large number ("70+", "25-30", "9 to 12") on the other. Pehla Qadam, IT Box, Chaddar, CSP, each with a "Learn more" link
4	Yearly drives	A horizontal strip through the year (Ramadan, Winter, School season) with one large image per drive; drag or scroll sideways. Shows the number of phases and the latest edition
5	Stories	One large quote at a time, with a photo on the left, in Fraunces. Pass-out students and women graduates, with consent
6	Sponsor a child	Full-width Dawn (pale gold) band, large headline, amount chips (monthly tiers), one gold button
7	Latest news and drives	One large featured post plus a list of three smaller ones
8	Join the team	Ink band with the ten team names as a scrolling line; button "Join a team"
9	Footer	As in section 7

Other pages

Page	Layout and signature element
Our Story	Split hero (founding photo and "Founded in 2014"). Long-form story in a narrow column. A vertical timeline from 2014 to today: a gold line draws as you scroll and each milestone fades in, alternating left and right
About and Cabinets	Mission and vision block. Current cabinet as a photo grid by level (Cabinet and Heads first and larger, then Co-Heads, Members, Executive, General in smaller grids). A year selector (pills from 2014 to today) switches the archive with a 300 ms cross-fade

Page	Layout and signature element
Project page (template)	Cover photo with overlay, a facts bar (timing, location, cost, seats), story text, gallery, results or batches, then one call to action (Sponsor or Donate). Admission note box: "Admissions are in person near Gate 2" with a map link
Pehla Qadam	Facts bar (70+ children, nursery to matric, evening, free), annual results table, pass-out stories carousel, teacher hierarchy graphic
IT Box	Batch cards (boys and girls, 2 each per year, 25-30 seats), skills list, certificate preview, link to Verify Certificate
Chaddar	Warm photo-led page, timing strip (9:00 am to 12:00 pm daily), skills and certification, women's stories
CSP	Explainer with three simple steps, tier chips, a "where your money goes" bar split by program, FAQ, sponsor form
Drive pages	Edition archive by year with large counters, photo masonry, downloadable report. Phase labels for Ramadan and Lihaf drives. No beneficiary data
Teams	Ten teams as an index list on the left and a detail panel on the right (desktop); accordion on mobile. Current heads shown with photos
Impact	Year filter, big numerals, simple bar charts in gold and ink, report downloads, story links
Gallery	Masonry grid by album, lightbox, fade-in on scroll, album filter pills
News and blog	Magazine layout, one featured post, clean reading width, share buttons
Donate	Two columns: left a short reassurance (where money goes, verified process), right the form with amount chips, purpose dropdown, payment details and proof upload. A progress stepper (1 Amount, 2 Pay, 3 Upload proof)

Page	Layout and signature element
Join a team	Team picker as large selectable tiles, then a short form; a thank-you screen with next steps
Verify certificate	Centered, one big input; result card with a Leaf (green) or Brick (red) status, name, program and batch
Contact	Form, WhatsApp button, embedded map to Gate 2, UET Taxila landmark note

9. Animation System

Principles: animate only `transform` and `opacity`; keep durations between 200 and 700 ms; one main motion per screen; motion must explain (reveal, guide, confirm) and never delay the content; every animation switches off under `prefers-reduced-motion`.

Where	Animation	Timing
Scroll reveal	Fade in and rise 24 px, once, items 80 ms apart	600 ms, ease `cubic-bezier(.22,1,.36,1)`
Headings	Line-by-line reveal from behind a mask	700 ms
Photos	Clip-path reveal from the bottom with the image scaling 1.08 to 1	800 ms
Counters	Count up from 0 when 40% visible, once	1.6 s, ease-out
Primary button	Ember layer wipes in from the left on hover; arrow nudges 4 px	250 ms
Cards and rows	Image zooms to 1.04; title underline sweeps in	500 ms
Header	Transparent to white after 80 px; hides on scroll down	250 ms
Gold line under headings	"Writes" itself left to right when it enters the screen	700 ms

Where	Animation	Timing
Our Story timeline	The vertical line draws with scroll position; entries fade in	scrubbed
Cabinet archive	Year pills switch the grid with a cross-fade; member photos go from gray to color on hover	300 ms
Donate chips	Selected chip fills Dawn with a gold border (spring)	150 ms
Page change	Soft fade between pages, no full-screen wipes (the only wipe is the opening loader)	250 ms
Forms	Errors shake once (4 px) and show Brick text; success shows a check drawing in	300 ms

Tools: Framer Motion (Motion) for component animations and reveals, GSAP ScrollTrigger only for the Our Story timeline if needed. Avoid heavy smooth-scroll libraries on low-end phones.

10. Components

Component	Specification
Primary button	Gold fill, Ink text, 48 px high, pill shape, bold 16 px
Secondary button	1.5 px Ink border (white border on dark), transparent, same size
Text link	Ink with a gold underline that thickens to Ember on hover
Tags	Pill, Paper fill, 12 px caps text (for example "Ramadan", "Phase 1")
Cards	White, Mist border, 10 px radius; photo on top with 4:3 ratio; no shadow

Component	Specification
Counter	Fraunces numeral, gold underline, small Pen Gray label
Member card	Portrait 4:5 photo, name in Fraunces, designation and team in small gray text
Inputs	48 px high, Mist border, Gold focus ring (2 px), labels above, errors in Brick below
Amount chips	Pill, Mist border; selected: Dawn fill and Gold border
Timeline	Vertical gold line, Ink dots, year in Fraunces
Tables (results, reports)	No zebra stripes; Mist row lines; sticky header on mobile

11. Mobile and Low Bandwidth

Most visitors in Pakistan will arrive on phones, often on slow data.

- Design mobile first. Touch targets at least 44 px.
- Images in WebP via `next/image`, with sizes set per layout; total home page weight under 2 MB without the video.
- The hero video loads only on desktop with a good connection; phones get the poster.
- Sticky bottom bar on mobile with Donate and WhatsApp buttons after the hero.
- Use `font-display: swap` and subset fonts. Keep Urdu text in one font file.
- Plan for an Urdu and English switch later: use logical spacing (start and end) so right-to-left layouts do not break.

12. Accessibility Checklist

- Text contrast at least 4.5:1 (3:1 for large text); check the overlay on the brightest video frame.
- All images have alt text; decorative rays and lines are hidden from screen readers.
- Visible keyboard focus (Gold ring with an Ink offset) on every control.
- Video has a pause control; autoplay is muted.

- Reduced-motion mode for loader, reveals, counters and video.
- Form fields have labels and clear error messages; do not rely on color alone for status.

13. Assets the Society Must Provide

Asset	From	Details
Logo files	Graphics	Light and dark logos as SVG or transparent PNG (1080 px or larger), plus a compact mark without the curved lettering; favicon set
Hero video	Media and Coverage	10 to 15 s montage, 1080p, shot horizontally with calm camera movement: evening classroom, IT Box lab, Chaddar, a distribution event
Photo set	Media and Coverage	40 to 60 high-quality photos across all projects and drives, with guardian consent for children
Impact numbers	Documentation	Confirmed figures for counters and the Impact page
Copy	Documentation	Headline choice, project texts, founding story, short bios
Cabinet photos	Project Management	Square or portrait, plain background, consent for web use
Exact brand colors	Graphics	Confirm the measured hex values in section 2 against the master logo file

Photo style: natural light, eye-level, candid moments of teaching, learning and handing over items. No staged group lines holding boxes at the camera, and no faces of children without consent.

14. UI Build Checklist

- [ ] Brand colors confirmed and set in CSS variables and the Tailwind theme
- [ ] Fonts loaded with `next/font` (Fraunces, Source Sans 3, Noto Nastaliq Urdu)
- [ ] Logo SVGs added and tested on white, ink and video backgrounds
- [ ] Loader built, runs once per session, honors reduced motion

- [ ] Hero video and poster compressed; overlay tested on the brightest frame
- [ ] Header and mobile menu with the permanent Donate button
- [ ] Home page sections built in the order of section 8
- [ ] Reveal, counter and hover animations built as shared components
- [ ] Cabinet archive and Our Story timeline built
- [ ] Pages tested on a low-end Android phone on slow data
- [ ] Contrast and keyboard checks passed
- [ ] Lighthouse performance and accessibility scores reviewed before launch